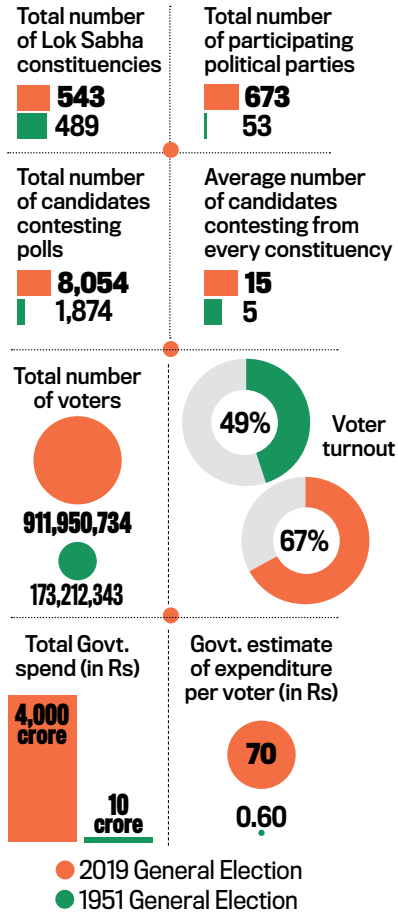
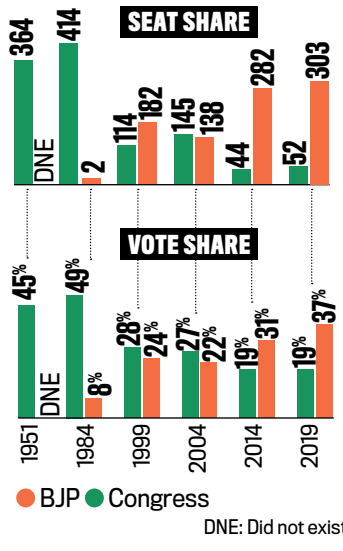
HOW THE GENERAL ELECTIONS CHANGED

While the number of participating political parties increased 13 times and the size of electorate increased six-fold, the cost of polls went up by 400 times



CENTRE FOR MEDIA STUDIES (CMS) PEGGED THE ABOVE EXPENDITURE AT ₹Rs 55,000-60,000 cr. FOR THE 2019 LOK SABHA POLLS (RS 700 PER VOTER)

THE CHANGING FORTUNES OF TWO NATIONAL PARTIES



DNE: Did not exist

THE GENDER GAP

With Parliament yet to pass the bill for reservation of women in our legislatures, the share of women MPs and MLAs has been abysmally low

WOMEN MEMBERS IN LOK SABHA

81 [15%]
17th (2019-2024)

24 [5%]
1st (1951-1957)

WOMEN MEMBERS IN RAJYA SABHA

33 [13%]
17th (2019-2024)

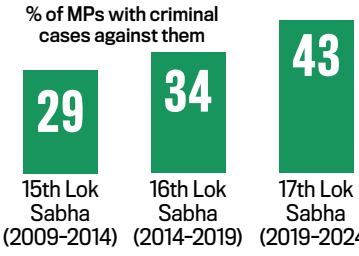
12 [6%]
1st (1951-1957)

WOMEN MLAS ACROSS STATES

354 [9%]
2022

THE RISE IN CRIMINALITY

MPs with criminal records have been steadily growing in the Lok Sabha



29% OF THE CASES REGISTERED AGAINST 233 MPS ARE RELATED TO RAPE, MURDER, ATTEMPT TO MURDER OR CRIME AGAINST WOMEN

DEMOCRACY AND WEALTH

The elected representatives in the Lok Sabha are much wealthier than the people they represent

₹21 crore
Average assets of a 17th Lok Sabha MP

₹10 lakh
Average household wealth per adult

Sources: Association for Democratic Reforms; World Inequality Report, 2021, published by Paris School of Economics and the University of Berkeley, California

475
Lok Sabha MPs are crorepatis

by the Congress. The party's domination continued till 1967. Its internal feuds created fragments that crystallised into newer parties—Swatantra in the 1960s, Janata in the 1970s. These often overlapped with or segued into politics writ from the periphery rather than the centre. Regional parties rode the surf of identity and culture in Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, Odisha, Punjab, Assam. Social blocs created another analogue in caste-based parties like the SP, RJD and BSP. If splinter parties like TMC, NCP, TRS, YSRCP—coming in a steady birth rate since the 1990s—weakened the Congress in the states, the centre didn't hold against the electoral march of the BJP. Saffron re-ordered electoral politics, using money, muscle, technology, predation and the cult around Prime Minister Narendra Modi. In a sense, the unitary model is reborn in him, as the perennial battle between centre and periphery rages. ■